

huge renovation program aimed at restoring Cuyper's lavish interiors.

Forth Bridge

Location Firth of Forth, Scotland

By any measure, Scotland's Forth Bridge is an impressive engineering feat. When it was opened in 1890, it was easily the longest bridge in the world. It spans a length of 8,094 ft (2,467 m), and its two central sections are each 1,709 ft (521 m) long. About 58,000 tons (53,000 tonnes) of steel were used, along with 640,000 cubic ft (18,000 cubic m) of granite for the 12 piers that support the steel structure. The bridge is thought to contain 6.5 million rivets. At the peak of its construction, it required 4,600 workers—of whom 57 were killed. It cut the journey time between London and Aberdeen by almost 5 hours.

interior of the building was startlingly novel. A private house, built between 1893 and 1894, it is considered the first building in the Art Nouveau style, which dominated the arts between about 1890 and 1910. For the first time, here was a house that did not look back to historical models, but created an

entirely new architectural language of its own. The building's unity was ensured by Horta having designed every detail. The most notable aspects of its revolutionary interior are the central light well, which floods the space with yellowish light, and the use of an open plan, with rooms and spaces flowing together.

Hôtel Tassel

Location Brussels, Belgium

If externally, Victor Horta's Hôtel Tassel generally follows Classical examples, albeit modified, the

